

**SINGLE SOURCE DETERMINATION USING
SIMPLIFIED ACQUISITION PROCEDURES (SAP)
FOR AN ACTION NOT EXCEEDING THE SIMPLIFIED ACQUISITION THRESHOLD
(AUTHORITY: 41 U.S.C. 1901 and FAR Part 12.102(a))**



1. Agency and contracting activity. Department of Commerce, NOAA Acquisition and Grants Office (AGO), National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration (NOAA), National Marine Fisheries Service (NMFS) and Southwest Fisheries Science Center (SWFSC), Marine Mammal and Turtle Division (MMTD).

2. Description of supplies or services required to meet agency needs (including the estimated value).

SWFSC requires genotyping sequencing services. This project will generate mtDNA and nDNA data for samples obtained by SWFSC to fill in critical knowledge gaps for Atlantic green and loggerhead turtles, using customized arrays of markers that are compatible with published and in-progress studies. These include standard mtDNA Control Region (CR) sequences for all samples, plus additional informative mtDNA markers for green turtles, and arrays of nDNA microsatellite markers individually customized for each species. The data produced will allow GSI of loggerhead bycatch and relocation trawl sample sets, finescale stock structure analysis of Atlantic green turtles, connectivity of green turtles foraging in critical US habitat, and analysis to delineate Atlantic DPS boundaries, all SAIP priorities that will inform current and upcoming NMFS Biological Opinions and population assessments.

Period of Performance:

Base Year:		2026 -		2027
Option Year 1:		2027 -		2028
Option Year 2:		2028 -		2029
Option Year 3:		2029 -		2030
Option Year 4:		2030 -		2031



Contract Type: Firm Fixed Price

3. Identification of the single source or the brand name to be solicited.

Vendor Name: University of Georgia

Address: 180 E Green Street

Athens, Georgia 30602-2152



4. Supporting rationale. Only one source or brand name is reasonably available as detailed below:

- ☐ Other - Only one source is capable - The University of Georgia is uniquely positioned to provide data that meet the requirements for this project, since they are the only laboratory we could identify that has already developed separate customized assays that are able to distinguish the genetic stocks of

Atlantic loggerhead and green turtle populations to the fine geographic scale that we need for our analysis. They have an extensive R&D based knowledge and have optimized the multiplex PCR protocols that assure that the data produced will be compatible with published, ongoing and future baseline datasets that will allow us to conduct informative downstream genetic stock analysis. There is an immediate need to generate data for a backlog of samples at SWFSC using informative mtDNA and nDNA markers to allow Genetic Stock Identification (GSI) in order to achieve current scientific and management objectives identified under the NMFS protected species Stock Assessment Improvement Plan (SAIP). The newly proposed Critical Habitat for green turtles in waters surrounding these US territories (88 FR 46572) elevates the need to improve the genetic nesting population baseline dataset to improve capacity to determine connectivity with critical habitat at the Distinct Population Segment (DPS) scale.

5. Market Research.

Commercial sequencing and genotyping has primarily been developed to meet the human, biomedical and agricultural needs. For endangered species, it remains a research-driven process, primarily conducted through genomics centers at universities. While there are companies that provide genotyping services, and mtDNA sequencing, the University of Georgia is the only laboratory to have developed targeted assays that have been optimized and are currently routinely in high throughput production. After thorough market research, no other vendors are capable of performing the specific tasks needed for our project. Market research report is maintained in the contract file.

6. Technical/Requirements Representative Certification

I certify that this requirement constitutes the Government's minimum needs and the supporting data provided herein is accurate and complete to the best of my knowledge and belief.

Program Leader

Date

Deputy Science and Research Director
Southwest Fisheries Science Center

Date



7. Determination

I hereby determine that the circumstances of this action deem only one source is reasonably available. This determination is accurate and complete to the best of my knowledge and belief.

Contracting Officer

Date